

Questions to Ask at the Pharmacy

The ten questions that save the most money and prevent the most mistakes

1	Is the cash price lower than my copay? Pharmacies are allowed to tell you, but many won't unless you ask.
2	Is this on your discount generic list? Hundreds of common generics are \$4 to \$10 for a month's supply.
3	Can this be written for a 90-day supply? Many plans charge two copays for three months.
4	Is there a generic or a therapeutic alternative? Same job, often a fraction of the price. Your doctor has to approve the switch.
5	Does the manufacturer have a coupon or patient assistance program? Brand-name drugs often do. Search the drug name plus 'patient assistance program'.
6	Why did my price change? Formulary changes, a new deductible year, or a manufacturer switch. The pharmacist can see the reason.
7	Was this denied, or does it just need a prior authorization? Most 'denials' are paperwork. Ask the doctor's office to file the appeal or PA.
8	Can you sync all my refills to the same day? One trip a month, and nothing runs out on a Sunday.
9	Is this new pill the same medication? Generic manufacturers change. Ask them to confirm before you take it.
10	What should I do if I miss a dose? The answer is different for every drug. Write the answer next to that medication on your master list.

Every one of these is explained step by step in **The Smart Pharmacy Guide** by Josh Hagar, CPhT, available on Amazon in paperback and Kindle.

Medication Master List

One line per medication · Include vitamins, supplements, and over-the-counter products

Name:

Date of birth:

Last updated:

MEDICATION	STRENGTH	HOW OFTEN / WHEN	WHAT IT'S FOR	PRESCRIBER	PHARMACY / RX #

Allergies / reactions:

Emergency contact: